



Intel Burst vs. Turbo Boost

Intel's myriad architectural changes and nomenclature might be confusing. Here's a quick refresher: <http://dgit.in/1gu5oXs>



The life of a genius

Also known as the heart and soul of the Apple Store, here's a look at the life of an Apple Store Genius <http://dgit.in/1nlTgbK>



Dell Venue 8 Pro

cations. Nonetheless, the tablet has an appealing design with nice, metal hardware buttons on the edges. The back is rubberized with a textured finish which offers good grip. The placement of the Windows Start key is a bit annoying as it is placed right on one corner, making it difficult to reach. This leaves you only using the on screen Start button.

The Acer Iconia W4 is a standard looking tablet with the front display covered with glass surrounded by a silver bezel which curves out at the bottom and houses the Windows Start hardware key. The tablet is a bit bulky at 10mm, but with an 8-inch display, it isn't all that huge. The back can easily be presumed to have a metal finish though in reality it is all plastic back with a metal like paint finish. It gives it a nice touch and lends it a more premium air. There is also a 5MP primary camera and a secondary 2MP camera which offers full HD recording capabilities which is great for making video calls. The W4 comes with an 8-inch IPS display with a resolution

of 1280x800 pixels. It is bright and vibrant and viewing angles too are pretty good. The only issues again, as we saw on the Dell Venue 8 Pro, is the tiny little screen and the fact that the Windows 8 desktop is a pain to use. Apart from the standard OTG enabled microUSB port, the tablet also has a micro HDMI port which is useful if you want to attach an external display.

The biggest tablet of the lot is HP's Omni 10 with a 10.1-inch display offering a cracking resolution of 1920x1200. It makes sense to have such a high resolution on a 10.1-inch display as it improves the pixel density and thus, the sharpness. The display is far superior to the ones discussed above but offers almost similar brightness and contrast levels. The overall design of the Omni 10 is quite good, with the back panel having a matte plastic finish. There is a capacitive Start button, which is quite convenient when switching between the tile and desktop modes. The tablet also has an 8MP rear and 2MP front camera, which takes average quality pictures, but are useful when making video calls. Like the Acer tablet, the Omni 10 also has a micro HDMI port to

expand or mirror your display onto external devices. The only concern with the design was the proprietary charging port and the fact that you can't charge the device via the micro-USB port. You'd think manufacturers would have caught on by now.

All three tablets support external keyboards and mice, which can be connected via Bluetooth or the microUSB port. This makes it much easier to operate the tablet if you really need to type a lot, but that's not really what these devices are for in the first place.

HARDWARE AND PERFORMANCE

Having a powerful hardware package is crucial as almost every vendor is bringing out exceptionally fast devices at a lower price range. All the three tablets are powered by Intel based processors which also means that they offer decent battery life.

The Acer Iconia W4 runs on an Intel Atom processor Z3740 quad-core processor clocked at 1.33GHz which can go upto 1.86GHz thanks to the Intel's Burst technology. There is 2GB of RAM, 64GB of internal memory and also a microSD card slot to further expand the storage. The graphics are backed up by Intel's HD Graphics chip.

In the connectivity department you get Wi-Fi, Bluetooth, GPS and also 3G via the microSIM card slot. There is also a non-3G version of the tablet which is available at a much lower price. To provide the power, the Iconia W4 is equipped with a 4960mAh battery



Acer Iconia W4

pack. The 8-inch display on the tablet offers an 1280x800, which seems decent and doesn't look too shabby.

The Dell Venue 8 Pro runs on a similar Intel Atom processor Z3740D quad-core processor as on the Acer tablet which has a clock speed of 1.33GHz with Intel Burst speed of 1.86GHz coupled with 2GB of RAM and Intel HD Graphics. There is 32GB of internal storage which you can expand using a microSD card. The 8-inch display comes with the 1280x800 resolution offering a similar experience as the Iconia W4. The battery pack on the Venue 8 Pro has a rating of 4830mAh which is slightly less than the Iconia W4, but surprisingly it performed better in our battery tests.

The 10.1-inch, the HP Omni 10 has the best hardware among the three, sporting a faster, Intel Atom Z3770 quad-core processor with a base speed of 1.4GHz and a burst speed of 2.4GHz. There is 2GB of RAM and 32GB of internal storage which can be expanded via a microSD card. The resolution on the 10.1-inch display is 1920x1200 which



HP Omni 10